Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

Third Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination October 2025

Discipline Specific Core Course -- MG3DSCSWK200-Socialwork Practice with Communities and Social Action **- QP Code**: 25900632

Part A Short Answer Questions Answer all questions / each question carries 1 marks

1	Mention the period in community organization focused on training and professionalism. → *1950s–1960s*	U]/[CO1] 1 mark
2	Name the three approaches suggested by Robert Fisher. → *Locality Development, Social Planning, and Social Action*	[K]/ [CO3] 1 mark
3	Define commons as per Eleanor Ostrom. → *Commons are shared resources managed collectively by a community according to rules and norms that ensure their sustainable use.*	[U]/ [CO6] 1 mark
4	Name one visual method used in PRA. → *Mapping* (e.g., social map, resource map)	[S]/ [CO5] 1 mark
5	State the model that highlights the redistribution of power and resources. → *Social Action Model*	[K]/ [CO3] 1 mark
6	Mention one type of observation skill useful in social work practice. → *Participant Observation*	[A]/ [CO4] 1 mark
7	Identify the primary occupation of people in rural communities. → *Agriculture*	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark
8	State one objective of the evaluation stage. → *To assess the effectiveness and impact of a program or intervention*	[K]/ [CO2] 1 mark
9	Cite one leader associated with peasant struggles. → *Swami Sahajanand Saraswati* (also acceptable: *Mahatma Gandhi*, *E.M.S. Namboodiripad*, depending on context)	[S]/ [CO5] 1 mark
10	Cite one instance where the facilitator role becomes important in group meetings → *During conflict resolution or decision-making discussions*	[A]/ [CO4] 1 mark

Part B- Short answer- Answerany5questions- Eachquestioncarries3marks

11.	Elaborate on the scope and relevance of community organization. ➢ Community organization covers a wide range of activities aimed at empowering communities to identify needs, plan actions, and mobilize resources. ➢ It is relevant because it promotes collective decision-making, social justice, and sustainable development by strengthening community participation and leadership.	[U]/ [CO1] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
12.	Explain the relationship between social action and community organization. ➢ Social action is a method within community organization focused on bringing about structural change and redistributing power and resources. ➢ While community organization builds participation and cooperation, social action emphasizes advocacy and confrontation to address inequality and injustice.	[A]/ [CO6] 3 marks
13.	Describe the significance of the women's rights movement. The women's rights movement is significant as it challenged gender discrimination, promoted equality, and secured legal and social reforms. It led to improvements in education, employment, and political representation, empowering women to participate fully in all spheres of life.	[S]/[CO5] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
14.	Analyse how the communicator role helps in mobilizing people. ➢ The communicator role helps mobilize people by sharing information clearly, building awareness, and inspiring collective action.\ ➢ Effective communication bridges gaps, motivates participation, and strengthens unity among community members toward common goals.	[An]/ [CO4] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
15.	How does the value of human relationships guide community work? ➢ It emphasizes trust, respect, and mutual support in community work. ➢ It guides practitioners to collaborate empathetically with community members,	[U]/ [CO1] 1.5

	fostering cooperation and a sense of belonging essential for effective problem-solving and development.	marks 1.5 marks
16.	Define general content approach. ➢ The general content approach in community organization focuses on the common processes and principles applicable to all types of communities. ➢ It emphasizes stages such as study, planning, action, and evaluation, regardless of the specific issue or setting.	[U]/ [CO3] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
17.	Describe the importance of planning in social action. ➢ Planning in social action is essential for setting clear objectives, identifying strategies, and ensuring efficient resource use. ➢ It helps coordinate activities, anticipate challenges, and achieve social change systematically and effectively.	[S]/[CO5] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks

Part C- Short essay- Answerany3questions- Eachquestioncarries5marks

18.	Differentiate between observation skills and analytical skills, giving examples from community social work. ➢ **Definition:** Observation skills involve carefully watching and listening to understand people and situations, while analytical skills involve interpreting the information gathered to make informed decisions. ➢ **Purpose:** Observation helps identify visible behaviors or conditions (e.g., poor sanitation), whereas analysis helps understand underlying causes (e.g., lack of municipal services). ➢ **Process:** Observation is direct and sensory; analysis involves reasoning, comparison, and critical thinking. ➢ **Example:** A social worker observes low attendance in a women's meeting (observation) and analyzes that cultural restrictions or timing issues are the causes (analysis). ➢ **Outcome:** Together, they help in accurate problem assessment and effective intervention planning in community work.	[An]/ [CO4] 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark
19.	Compare the sociological and social work views of community life in everyday situations. 1. **Sociological View:** Focuses on studying the structure, functions, and dynamics of community life objectively. 2. **Social Work View:** Emphasizes practical engagement, empowerment, and problem-solving within the community. 3. **Approach:** Sociology explains *why* things happen; social work focuses on *how* to bring positive change. 4. **Example:** A sociologist studies caste relations; a social worker facilitates dialogue to reduce discrimination. 5. **Integration:** Both views are complementary—sociological understanding supports effective community interventions.	[U]/ [CO1] 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark
20.	Explain the Gandhian approach with an example. ➢ **Philosophy:** Based on truth, non-violence, and self-reliance for holistic community development. ➢ **Sarvodaya:** Aims for the welfare of all, emphasizing moral and spiritual development. ➢ **Self-sufficiency:** Promotes local production and decentralized governance through Panchayati Raj. ➢ **Constructive Work:** Encourages education, sanitation, and village industries for empowerment. ➢ **Example:** *Gram Swaraj*—villages governing themselves through collective decision-making and sustainable living.	[U]/ [CO3] 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark
21.	Demonstrate how Alinsky's strategies can be used in community development. 1. **Power Building:** Mobilize local people to gain collective bargaining power. 2. **Issue-based Action:** Focus on specific, solvable issues that unite the community.	[A]/ [CO6] 1 mark 1 mark

	3. **Conflict as a Tool:** Use non-violent confrontation to challenge injustice and authorities. 4. **Leadership Development:** Train local leaders to represent and sustain movements. 5. **Example:** Organizing residents to demand better housing or water facilities through public campaigns.	1 mark 1 mark 1 mark
22.	Appraise the application of a PRA technique such as social mapping in supporting participatory planning. 1. **Definition:** Social mapping is a Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) tool where community members draw maps showing households, resources, and social features. 2. **Participation:** Encourages local involvement and ownership in the planning process. 3. **Information Sharing:** Helps identify resource distribution, vulnerable groups, and community priorities. 4. **Decision-Making:** Guides equitable and informed development planning. 5. **Outcome:** Enhances transparency, inclusiveness, and sustainability of community development projects.	[S]/[CO5] 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark 1 mark

Part C- Essay- Answer any 2questions- Each question carries 15marks

23.	Analyze community development and explain how it complements community organization in practice. Community development is a process aimed at improving the living standards and quality of life of people through collective action. It focuses on empowerment, participation, and capacity building. Community organization provides the structure and method to facilitate this development. 1. **Concept of Community Development:** o Seeks economic, social, and cultural progress of the community. o Encourages people's participation and self-reliance. 2. **Concept of Community Organization:** o A professional social work method that involves organizing people to identify needs, plan actions, and mobilize resources. 3. **Complementary Nature:** o **Participation:** Community organization mobilizes people, while development implements programs. o **Empowerment:** Organization builds leadership and voice; development offers opportunities for growth. o **Integration:** Organization provides process; development provides content. 4. **Practical Example:** o In rural health projects, community organization helps form local health committees; community development implements health awareness and sanitation drives. 5. **Outcome:** o Sustainable development through community ownership, cooperation, and empowerment. **Conclusion:** Community development and community organization are interdependent—the former gives direction and goals, while the latter provides the method and structure to achieve them.	[U]/ [CO1] 2 marks 12 marks 1 mark
24.	Assess the relevance of community organisation as a social work method in India highlighting major government and NGO initiatives Community organization is a vital method of social work in India that emphasizes collective action and empowerment to address social and economic issues. 1. **Relevance in India:** o Addresses poverty, inequality, and social exclusion. o Empowers marginalized groups through participation and advocacy. 2. **Government Initiatives:** o **Community Development Programme (1952):** Foundation of participatory rural development. o **National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM):** Promotes self-help groups and women's empowerment. o **Swachh Bharat Mission & MGNREGA:** Encourage community participation in sanitation and employment.	[U]/ [CO2] 2 marks 12 marks

	3. **NGO Initiatives:** o **SEWA:** Organizes women workers for economic empowerment. o **MYRADA and PRADAN:** Promote community-based institutions and livelihood initiatives. o **ActionAid, CARE India:** Focus on rights-based community development. 4. **Social Work Practice:** o Used in urban slums, tribal areas, and disaster rehabilitation. o Builds local leadership and promotes participatory governance. 5. **Challenges and Significance:** o Despite bureaucratic hurdles, it remains key for inclusive and sustainable development. **Conclusion:** Community organization continues to be a relevant and powerful method for strengthening democracy, promoting participation, and achieving social justice in India.	1 mark
25.	Review the approaches and strategies of social action with examples. Social action is a method of social work aimed at bringing about structural change by challenging injustice and empowering marginalized groups. 1. **Meaning:** o Collective effort to change policies, practices, or structures that oppress people. 2. **Approaches of Social Action:** ➢ **Gandhian Approach:** Non-violent, moral persuasion and constructive work (e.g., Salt Satyagraha). ➢ **Marxian Approach:** Radical and confrontational, focusing on class struggle and redistribution. ➢ **Alinsky's Approach:** Pragmatic, power-based, and issue-oriented (e.g., community campaigns in Chicago). 3. **Strategies:** o **Awareness Building:** Educating people about their rights. ➢ **Mobilization:** Uniting people for collective action. ➢ **Negotiation and Advocacy:** Engaging with authorities for reform. ➢ **Confrontation and Protest:** Non-violent resistance when negotiation fails. ➢ **Legal and Policy Interventions:** Using legal tools to ensure justice. 4. **Examples:** ➢ Chipko Movement (environmental protection). ➢ Narmada Bachao Andolan (displacement and rehabilitation). ➢ Anti-corruption campaigns and women's rights movements. ➢ **Outcome:**Promotes democracy, accountability, and social justice through active citizenship. **Conclusion:** Social action remains a powerful tool for achieving systemic change, promoting equality, and strengthening community participation.	[A]/ [CO6] 1 mark 13 mark 1 mark
26.	Analyse the role of leadership, advocacy, and networking in strengthening community organisation and ensuring sustainability of social action. Effective community organization and social action depend on strong leadership, advocacy, and networking to sustain collective efforts and ensure long-term impact. 1. **Leadership:** ➢ Provides vision, motivation, and direction. ➢ Helps identify issues and mobilize people. ➢ Example: Bunker Roy's leadership in Barefoot College empowered rural communities through education and technology. 2. **Advocacy:** ➢ Represents community interests and influences policy. ➢ Encourages rights-based approaches and resource mobilization. ➢ Example: Advocacy for the Right to Information (RTI) Act by civil society groups. 3. **Networking:** ➢ Builds alliances among NGOs, government, and communities. ➢ Facilitates sharing of resources, skills, and strategies. ➢ Example: National Campaign for People's Right to Information (NCPRI) brought diverse groups together. 4. **Integration in Practice:** ➢ Leadership mobilizes; advocacy influences change; networking sustains	[An]/ [CO4 1 mark 12 mark

	the process. ➢ Together, they ensure continuity beyond individual projects. **Outcome:** Empowered communities, strengthened institutions, and sustainable social change. **Conclusion:** Leadership, advocacy, and networking are pillars of successful community organization. They transform short-term movements into long-lasting social transformations.	1 mark 1 mark